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Post-Completion OPT

Jump to a Section

What Is Post-Completion OPT?

Post-Completion OPT is a type of work authorization for students in F-1 status, allowing them to work in the United States for up to 12 months after completing their degree program. It is one of three types of Optional Practical Training (OPT) available to USC students.

Employment must be directly related to the student's major field of study at USC. The student is required to maintain F-1 status and continue to report to OIS during the Post-Completion OPT period.

The OPT application will require a Form I-20 [illegible] by OIS before filing a formal application using the F[illegible]

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- Must be in the United States to file Form I-765.
- Do not need a job or a job offer to apply.

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How to Apply for Post-Completion OPT

The Post-Completion OPT application process must be completed in the following order:

1. Student submits OPT I-20 Request in Trojan International.
2. Student receives OPT I-20 from OIS via USC email.
3. Student files Form I-765, OPT I-20 and supporting documents to USCIS.
4. USCIS adjudicates the student's OPT ap
5. Student receives USCIS approval notific
6. Student begins working on or after the E
7. Student submits OPT employment infor onal.

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Filing the Form I-765

After receiving the OPT I-20 from OIS, students must file Form I-765 online via their myUSCIS account. If the student does not have an account with USCIS, they must create one.

Important Deadline Considerations

Before You File

How to File the Form I-765

Photo and Biometric Requirements

Social Media Vetting

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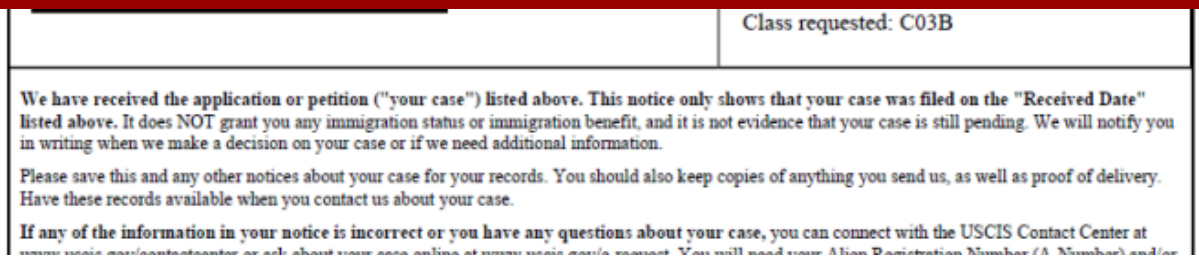
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Class requested: C03B

We have received the application or petition ("your case") listed above. This notice only shows that your case was filed on the "Received Date" listed above. It does NOT grant you any immigration status or immigration benefit, and it is not evidence that your case is still pending. We will notify you in writing when we make a decision on your case or if we need additional information.

Please save this and any other notices about your case for your records. You should also keep copies of anything you send us, as well as proof of delivery. Have these records available when you contact us about your case.

If any of the information in your notice is incorrect or you have any questions about your case, you can connect with the USCIS Contact Center at

Here is where to find your receipt number on your receipt notice, which you may use to check your case status.

As USCIS processing times vary and it can take several months for a decision to be adjudicated, we recommend that the student check current estimated processing times on the USCIS website. Select Form I-765, then choose the appropriate form category and processing office listed on your USCIS receipt notice.

If you filed the Form I-907, Request for Premium Processing Service, USCIS guarantees a response within 30 business days, not including weekends or holidays. Please note that attending the required biometrics appointment may cause the processing time to reset. Refer to the case status section of your myUSCIS portal for additional guidance.

Although a job is not required to apply for OP ewing for jobs while their OPT application is pending s once they receive their EAD in the mail and the start da

ving Approval and EAD from USCIS

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Creating an SEVP Portal Account (Optional)

The SEVP Portal allows F-1 students on approved OPT to view employment information as reflected in their SEVIS record. Creating an SEVP Portal account is optional.

Please note that students must still use the OIS forms above to report any changes to their U.S. address or OPT employment. **Do not submit any updates in the SEVP Portal, as changes made there will not be received or processed by OIS.**

When the status of an OPT request in SEVIS changes to "approved," SEVIS will notify the SEVP Portal. Students will then receive an email from do-not-reply.SEVP@ice.dhs.gov near the start of their OPT with a registration link for the SEVP Portal. Students must create their SEVP Portal account within 14 days of receiving this link, regardless of their employ ortal.

For additional guidance, refer to the SEVP Po tudy in the States website. If you have locked yourself o link has expired, complete the SEVP Portal Reset Req

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New Program of Study at USC

Transfer to Another Institution

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Change of Status

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Optional Practical Training FAQ

My city of birth is incorrect on my OPT I-20

I applied for a Reduced Course Load (RCL) course section on my I-20 is blank. Should

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I already submitted my OPT application to USCIS but I still have questions. How can I speak with an advisor?

What is the USCIS processing time for OPT applications?

My OPT I-20 does not have a travel endorsement on pages 2 or 3. Is this a problem?

My prior CPT information is not printed on my OPT I-20. Is this an error?

Can I travel while my OPT application is pending?

Can I enroll in classes while on OPT?

There's a mistake on my OPT EAD due to a

PT EAD got lost or stolen. What shoul

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I received a biometrics notice from USCIS. What should I do?

I received a Rejection, Request for Evidence or Denial Notice from USCIS. What should I do?

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Optional Practical Training

STEM OPT Extension

STEM OPT Extension Based on a Prior Degree

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